John Mahood School Council

Meeting Minutes February 26th, 2025

Present:

In Person:
Darrell Schinkle
Krista Weltz
Kristen Dorscht
Bryan Rankine
Leah Cressman
Stephanie Remple
Angie Melchin
Emily McConnell
Tabatha Nicholson

Online:
Laura Fehrenbach
Meaghan Hachey
Katy Armstrong
Bethany Metzger
Kacheena Morrison
Alicia McGuire

Voting Members Absent:

Kandis Walker
Courtney Dyer

Territorial Acknowledgement - Bryan

Spoke of Indigenous journalist who sadly passed away recently at age 61.
At each monthly staff meeting a different staff share their experience and connection with the Land acknowledgment. This month Ms Miller shared about a which she is reading with her Kindergarten students

Discussion of Previous Minutes - Kristen

- See last month's minutes Here
    - Accepted by - Stephanie
    - Seconded by - Angie

Principal's/Teacher Report - Bryan & Krista

- Wrapping up February Black Brilliance month - focussing on past and present black canadians
    - At the assembly the kids were really engaged and excited about the presentation.
    - Series of 5 videos and activities that happened in the classroom
    - Something we should focus on and celebrate throughout the year
    - Biographies of Black Canadians
    - Black Brilliance Leadership conference at EDSS was attended by a few of our students on Monday - the highschool has a Black Brilliance Club, and wanted to connect with some younger youth from area schools
- Staff have finished their middle of the year Acadiens reading assessment, to see if students are still on target from beginning of the year assessments.

    - All screening for students in SK-Gr 2 have been completed, it is only required to screen kids who did not reach the early year benchmark, but staff were able to screen all students
    - Working on organizing some small groups for targeted intervention with students who are falling behind
    - The screening can pinpoint specific problems that each individuals are facing
    - Gives the educator targeted intervention, prompts educator to look at different areas where they may not have noticed a weakness before if the student was meeting targets
- Reflex is another program for math skills development in a game platform
    - Fully adaptive for every kid
    - Provides teachers data on how the child is progressing
- Teachers PD for small group instruction
    - For more individualised instructions to children with similar learning needs
- Early reading resource teacher to come and work with Grade 1 and 2 teachers
- Four co-op students here from EDSS, starting this week
- Two student teachers
- Secret dress-up days by the teachers - was a lot of fun, kids loved it and the staff loved it
- Kodaly choir - performing on May 7th
    - Kids are doing some really difficult music, but doing a great job!
    - Singing at the Rangers Game on March 30th
- Crokinole Club is full and the interest is huge
- Trivia Club
- Yarn Club - very popular, runs wednesdays and fridays
- Field Trip to University Women's Hockey game in March
- Beach Day before March Break
- Eco Club Grant - a new eco grant was received
- Krista applied for a Music Grant and it was awarded
    - The hope to have the Kitchener Symphony come into the school
    - May request Council support to cover the balance
- Teachers would like to sign up to volunteer at MahoodFest

Chair's Report - Kristen/Stephanie

- PRO Grant
    - The plan was to do a joint parent presentation with other schools
    - We were approved for at least $500 (maybe $1500, waiting on clarification)
    - Location is Riverside on April 29th at 6:30
    - We are good to start advertising
- Elmira Maple Syrup Grant application was submitted

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- Staff appreciation breakfast
    - Thankyou for the contributions of food, there was a lot!
    - Teachers enjoyed
- Pizza - third round of Pizza to run starting in April
    - Sign-up to begin next week
- Bingo - April 3
    - Lions Hall
    - All we have to do is attend, advertise and help cleanup chairs
    - should to start advertising soon
    - We usually have a school table, everyone is welcome
    - 18+ event
- Pancake Day April 1st
    - Laura is happy get the supplies
    - Advertise starting next week looking for volunteers on school-day and social media - Darryl to start working on that
    - Mascott - Maybe get one of the co-op students to wear it
- MahoodFest May 13th
    - Committee has been meeting on Mondays, looking for more people to join the planning committee
    - Lots of activities in the works, some same as past years, some new
    - The committee is asking council to spend $2500 on MahoodFest to keep the activities and treats free/low cost for families
        - Popcorn and Cotton Candy: $795
        - Entertainment: Magic Shows, science tables, carnival games $1500
        - Misc Costs: Face painting, tablecloths, water, etc $205
    - historically MahoodFest has raised more money than it has spent
    - **Motion to spend $2500 on Mahoodfest - by Kristen**
        - **Passed by Majority vote**
    - Kristen will send Bryan a list of everything that is planned for his approval

Social Media - Katie

- Making a plan to post all of the things discussed this meeting
- More engagement would be helpful for visibility, there is currently not a lot of posts getting likes or shares
- Request to put out a post asking for Pizza Volunteers as they have been short the last couple of weeks

Treasury Report - Katie

- See Treasury Report Here

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- Pizza Sales: $5691
- Baden Coffee $700 profit
- Total available spend is just over $10,000
- Teachers are using their classroom spending amounts
- Large amounts cannot be carried year to year, so discussion on ways to spend some of the money we have available
    - Bryan has asked teachers to fill out the Google Form for areas of need within the school, will come to next meeting with ideas
    - Decodable books
    - Jungle Sport - Bryan to discuss with Leanne and we will revisit at the next meeting

Fundraising & Community Engagements

- Coffee went well
- Candy Fundraiser ongoing, orders due Friday
    - Pickup in the Library Thursday March 27th, 3-6pm
    - Unsure of when exactly the candy is going to be ready for pickup
        - Emily will reach out if she can't go pick up the candy
    - Helpers for pickup in the library on March 27th
        - Kristen available to help from 4-6pm

Open Discussion - All

- Suggestion to make a post about all of the initiatives we were able to implement this year through our fundraising
- Drop-Off and Pickup safety concerns posted on social media and people have contacted the school
    - Council was involved towards the end of Covid times with setting out cones
    - Parents parking at tennis courts and almost hitting children in the parking light
    - Issue with parents stopping on the street and dropping children off on the street
    - Parents and kids running across the road in front of the school instead of walking down to the cross-walk
    - Ensure people are walking along sidewalk to kindie area instead of through the parking lot
    - Will post on social media or school-day
- French Immersion
    - Class of 23 have been accepted, 6 students on a waitlist
    - People who have been accepted received an email, and need to confirm their acceptance by March 7th

    - Students that were not accepted and put on a waitlist did not receive communication, should hear more after March 7. Bryan to provide feedback to the french planning department about waitlisted families not being communicated with
    - In the future will do an information night, and more promotion for John Mahood
    - Actively looking to do a push to expand the program
- Kindergarten numbers looking similar to last year, likely 3.5 classes again next yearbut final numbers are not confirmed yet

Next meeting

- March 26th at 6pm

Additional discussion / activities after the meeting

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